

CISCO CCST CYBERSECURITY

Complete certification guide

From absolute beginner to exam preparation, booking and certification

Your goal

Learn the fundamentals, follow a structured plan, practise safely, take the official exam, and claim your credential after passing.

THE JOURNEY

1	Enrol Start with Cisco's recommended free learning path.
2	Study Build fundamentals and practise over a suggested 12–16 week schedule.
3	Prepare Review the current official exam objectives and test weak areas.
4	Book and take the exam Use the authorised registration route and follow check-in instructions.
5	Claim your credential Follow Cisco's instructions for your certification record and digital badge.

Important: Course names, exam prices, delivery options and requirements can change. Always confirm details on Cisco's official pages before paying.

1. Enrol in the official preparation course

Cisco recommends the Junior Cybersecurity Analyst Career Path for building knowledge relevant to CCST Cybersecurity. The path is self-paced; allow time to complete lessons and activities rather than rushing through them.

Junior Cybersecurity Analyst Career Path

Create a free account or sign in, search for the exact course name, open the course, and select the enrol/start option available on the current site.

- [Cisco Networking Academy](#)
- [Introductory cybersecurity course](#)

Official CCST exam and training information

Use the official exam page to verify the exam code, current objectives, price, duration and registration guidance. Use the training page if the course layout or name changes.

- [CCST Cybersecurity exam page](#)
- [Cisco support technician exams and training](#)

Suggested daily routine

Time	Task
35 minutes	Study a lesson and take short notes.
15 minutes	Revise concepts in your own words.
10 minutes	Answer questions or review mistakes.

2. Suggested 12–16 week study plan

This is a suggested pace for roughly one hour a day, six days per week. It is not an official Cisco timetable. Follow the current course sequence and exam blueprint if they differ.

Weeks 1–2 — Fundamentals

Study: CIA triad (confidentiality, integrity, availability), authentication vs authorisation, least privilege, threats, vulnerabilities, risk, malware and phishing.

Checkpoint: Explain core security terms and identify common social-engineering attempts.

Weeks 3–5 — Networking

Study: LAN/WAN, switches, routers, IPv4/IPv6 basics, MAC addresses, gateways, DNS, DHCP, TCP/UDP, ports and basic subnetting.

Checkpoint: Explain how a device gets an address and reaches a service.

Weeks 6–8 — Endpoint and network defence

Study: Operating-system updates, host firewalls, endpoint protection, accounts and permissions, secure configuration, backups, wireless security and network controls.

Checkpoint: Explain practical steps to reduce endpoint and network risk.

Weeks 9–10 — Vulnerability and risk

Study: Threats, vulnerabilities, exploits, risk likelihood and impact, patch priorities, asset inventory, security policies and defensive monitoring.

Checkpoint: Describe how to assess and prioritise a simple risk.

Weeks 11–12 — Incident handling

Study: Logs, alert triage, evidence preservation, incident response stages, threat intelligence and escalation.

Checkpoint: Explain how to respond to a suspected security incident.

Weeks 13–14 — Practice

Study: Repeat labs, revisit course activities, create flashcards, and review all incorrect practice answers.

Checkpoint: Complete basic tasks without step-by-step instructions.

Weeks 15–16 — Exam preparation

Study: Review the official exam objectives, focus on weak areas, and use reputable practice questions with explanations.

Checkpoint: Explain every exam topic in your own words and feel ready to sit the exam.

3. Hands-on practice checklist

Use your own computer or an authorised lab. Do not scan, test, or change security settings on an employer's production network without explicit permission.

Done	Exercise	Purpose
■	Run <code>ipconfig /all</code> on Windows.	See IP address, gateway, DNS and adapter settings.
■	Run <code>nslookup example.com</code> .	Observe a basic DNS lookup.
■	Run <code>ping 127.0.0.1</code> .	Test IPv4 loopback, not physical network connectivity.
■	Review Windows Update and Windows Security.	Understand updates, endpoint protection and firewall basics.
■	Analyse a fictional phishing email.	Spot suspicious senders, links, urgency and attachments.
■	Write a short incident report for a fictional malware alert.	Practise documentation and escalation.

4. Exam readiness checklist

- I completed the recommended course or equivalent study.
- I can explain all topics in the current official exam blueprint.
- I understand IP addressing, DNS, DHCP, TCP/UDP, ports, switches, routers and firewalls.
- I can distinguish a threat, vulnerability, exploit, risk and security control.
- I understand endpoint protection, access control, patching and incident response.
- I reviewed wrong answers and revisited weak topics.
- I checked current exam code, price, registration method, delivery options and ID rules.

5. Exam format and booking

Cisco has listed the CCST Cybersecurity exam as 100-160, with a 50-minute duration and a US\$125 price. These details can change, and the final price may differ due to taxes, currency conversion or regional availability. Confirm everything on the official exam page before booking.

Official exam details

Start here to review the current exam outline and follow the official registration route.

- [CCST Cybersecurity exam page](#)
- [Cisco exam registration guide](#)

Where to take the test

Option A — Authorised testing centre

Use the exam provider's scheduling flow to find available locations, dates and times. Select a centre that is convenient and verify the accepted ID requirements.

- [Cisco exams on Pearson VUE](#)

Option B — Online proctoring, if available

If online delivery is offered for this exam and region, check computer compatibility, webcam, internet, room rules, ID requirements and check-in time before booking.

- [Pearson VUE official website](#)

Booking steps

- Open the official Cisco CCST Cybersecurity exam page.
- Follow the exam scheduling link to the authorised provider.
- Sign in or create the required exam account.
- Enter your legal name exactly as shown on your accepted government-issued ID.
- Choose the exam, delivery method, date and time.
- Check the final price, cancellation policy and instructions, then pay and save your confirmation.
- Follow the provider's check-in and identification instructions on exam day.

6. After passing

- Follow the official instructions to view your result and certification record.
- Claim or access your digital badge through the platform Cisco specifies.
- Add the credential to your CV and professional profile.
- Keep practising networking, endpoint protection, logs and incident handling; the certification does not replace practical experience.

Certification and badge information

Use Cisco's official support/FAQ pages for current information about credential records and digital badges.

- [CCST certification FAQ](#)

Your first action today: create a Cisco Networking Academy account, search for “Junior Cybersecurity Analyst Career Path,” enrol, and begin the first module.

Reminder: certification helps demonstrate knowledge but does not guarantee a job or promotion. Always verify current exam details through Cisco and the authorised exam provider.